

STEFANO SCIBILIA

PhD Candidate in Political Science, Erasmus University Rotterdam

Policy, Politics, and Society · Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences
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RESEARCH PROFILE

Political scientist working on European Union governance and the domestic politics of socio-economic reform. My doctoral research examines how configurations of domestic politics shape the Europeanization of social policy, through in-depth process tracing of labour market and pension reforms in Italy and Spain (2011–2025) under the European Semester, the Recovery and Resilience Facility and the reformed Stability and Growth Pact, including the national recovery and fiscal-structural plans.

Research interests

EU governance · comparative political economy · social policy · case study research

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- 2023–present **PhD Candidate in Political Science**, Policy, Politics, and Society, Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences, Erasmus University Rotterdam. Since January 2023; completion expected June 2027.
- Doctoral research on how domestic politics shapes the Europeanization of socio-economic reform: causal process tracing of labour market and pension reforms in Italy and Spain (2011–2025), drawing on archival sources and interviews.
 - Researcher on the NWO-funded project *Towards a resilient European Union? Post-pandemic economic governance amidst politicisation* (PEGAP); principal investigator Markus Haverland.
 - Supervisors: prof. dr. Markus Haverland, dr. Asya Zhelyazkova, dr. Pieter Tuytens.

EDUCATION

- 2021–2022 **MSc in Political Science** (Political Economy track), University of Amsterdam.
- 2018–2020 **MSc in Economics**, Durham University Business School (UK).
Erasmus+ research stay for the MSc dissertation, Stockholm University, June–September 2019.
- 2014–2018 **BSc in Economics, Organizations and Finance** (Finance and Global Markets track), Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore, Milan.

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts under review

- 2026 **Scibilia, S.**, and Haverland, M. *From external to internal constraints? Nominal compliance and the Europeanization of socio-economic reforms under the Recovery and Resilience Facility in Spain*. Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Common Market Studies*.
- Scibilia, S.**, Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Domestic coalitions and (non)compliance in the European Semester: does the Recovery and Resilience Facility make a difference for Italian pension and labour market reforms?* Under review.

Conference papers

- 2026 **Scibilia, S.** *From the Recovery and Resilience Plans to the Medium-term Fiscal-structural Plans: the case of pension policy.* 13th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Catania, 1–3 July.
- Scibilia, S.,** and Haverland, M. *From external to internal constraints? Social pacts and socio-economic reforms under the Recovery and Resilience Facility in Spain.* 13th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Catania, 1–3 July.
- Scibilia, S.,** and Haverland, M. *Does RRF-induced centralization lead to structural reforms?* 22nd Netherlands Institute of Governance Annual Work Conference, Ghent, 5–6 February.
- Scibilia, S.** *Domestic coalitions and (non)compliance in the European Semester: does the Recovery and Resilience Facility make a difference in Italy?* X Convegno Società Italiana di Sociologia Economica (SISEC), Florence, 28–31 January.
- 2025 **Scibilia, S.,** Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Domestic coalitions and compliance in the European Semester: does the Recovery and Resilience Facility make a difference in Italy?* 19th Biennial Conference of the European Union Studies Association, Philadelphia, 8–10 May.
- Scibilia, S.,** Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Does the Recovery and Resilience Facility tilt the balance?* 21st Netherlands Institute of Governance Annual Work Conference, Ghent, 6–7 February.
- 2024 **Scibilia, S.,** Haverland, M., Tuytens, P., and Zhelyazkova, A. *Tilting the balance: the Recovery and Resilience Facility and labor market reforms inside the Italian political laboratory.* 12th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Lisbon, 19–21 June.
- 2023 **Scibilia, S.** *Continuity and change in EU governance: does the RRF alter the patterns of CSR compliance in the EU South?* 20th Netherlands Institute of Governance Annual Work Conference, Delft, 2–3 November.

TEACHING

- 2025 **Thesis supervision seminar** *Politics and Policy of the European Union*, BSc Management of International Social Challenges (MISOC), Erasmus University Rotterdam. 8 students; one thesis won the 2025 MISOC Impact Thesis Award.
- 2024 **Thesis supervision seminar** *European Union Governance in the Age of the Polycrisis*, BSc MISOC, Erasmus University Rotterdam. 8 students.
- 2023 **Thesis supervision seminar** *Reforming the South of the EU: a Path Hard to Follow*, BSc MISOC, Erasmus University Rotterdam. 5 students.

METHODS TRAINING

- Jul 2025 **MethodsNET Summer School**, Central European University, Vienna: Comparative Research Designs; Comparative Historical Analysis.
- Feb 2025 **ECPR Methods School** (online), KU Leuven: Process Tracing Methods; Interviews as Method of Data Collection in Times of Polarisation.
- 2023–2025 **Netherlands Institute of Governance** PhD courses: Formulating and Answering Research Questions; Responsibility and Integrity in Research / The Politics of Research; Classic Themes and Contemporary Challenges for Public Governance; Current Themes in EU Governance; Preparing Your Future Academic Career.

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND SOCIETAL OUTREACH

- Nov 2026 **Organiser**, *Lessons from and beyond the Recovery and Resilience Facility (RRF)*, a one-day event for EU and national policymakers on socio-economic reforms in the national recovery and fiscal-structural plans, with the European Social Observatory (OSE).
- 2025–2026 **Peer reviewer** for *Journal of European Public Policy*, *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, and *International Environmental Agreements: Politics, Law and Economics*.
- Member** of the European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR), the Netherlands Institute of Governance (NIG), and the Società Italiana di Sociologia Economica (SISEC).

LANGUAGES

Italian (native) · English (fluent) · Spanish (basic) · French (basic)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2020–2021 **Risk Management Intern**, Bosch Rexroth Italia, Cernusco sul Naviglio (Milan), December 2020 – August 2021: business continuity management and export-control compliance.